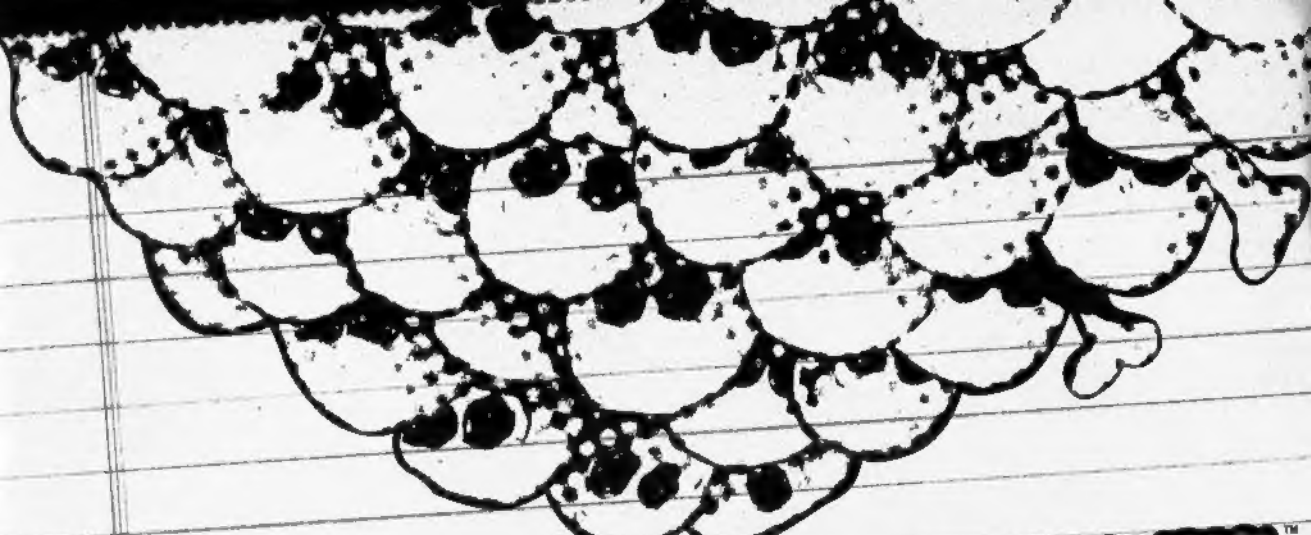



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APOCALYPSE NERD

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APOCALYPSE NERD

SOMEWHERE
IN THE
NORTH CASCADE
MOUNTAINS...

AHH,
THERE'S NOTHING
LIKE A WEEK IN THE
MOUNTAINS TO HELP
KEEP THINGS IN
PERSPECTIVE...

RIGHT,
PERRY?

OH, I
SUPPOSE...

...SIGH...



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YOU
"SUPPOSE"?

DON'T TELL
ME YOU'RE
STILL PINING
OVER THAT
BROAD...

I'm
NOT
PINING!

AND
SHE'S
NOT A
"BROAD"!



...I GUESS I'M
JUST FEELING LIKE
I'VE GOT NOTHING
TO GO BACK
TO...

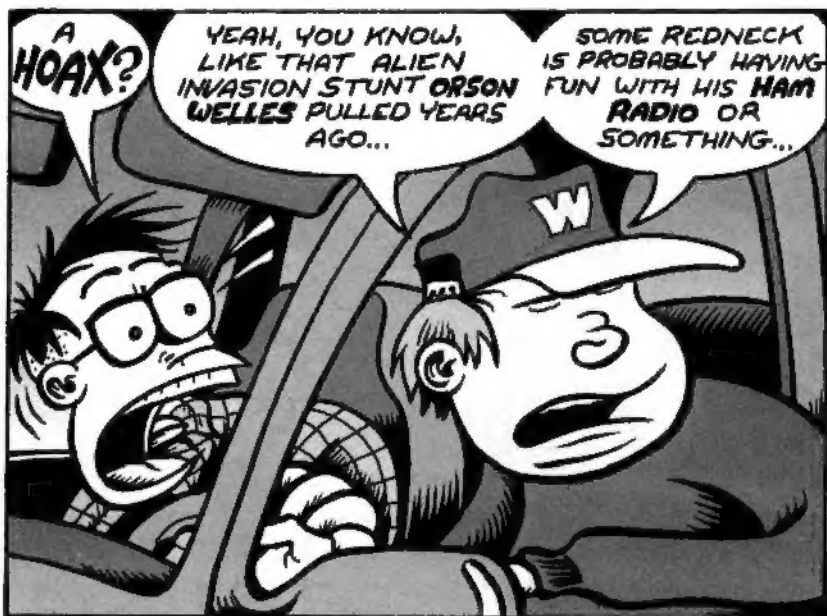
OH NO? WHAT
ABOUT YOUR
HIGH-FALOOTIN'
JOB?



BEEP!BEEP!

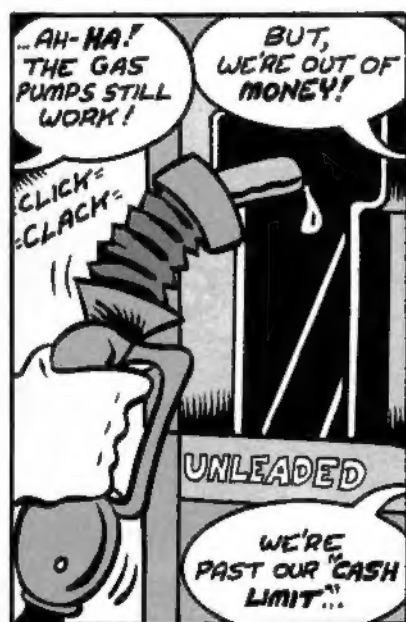


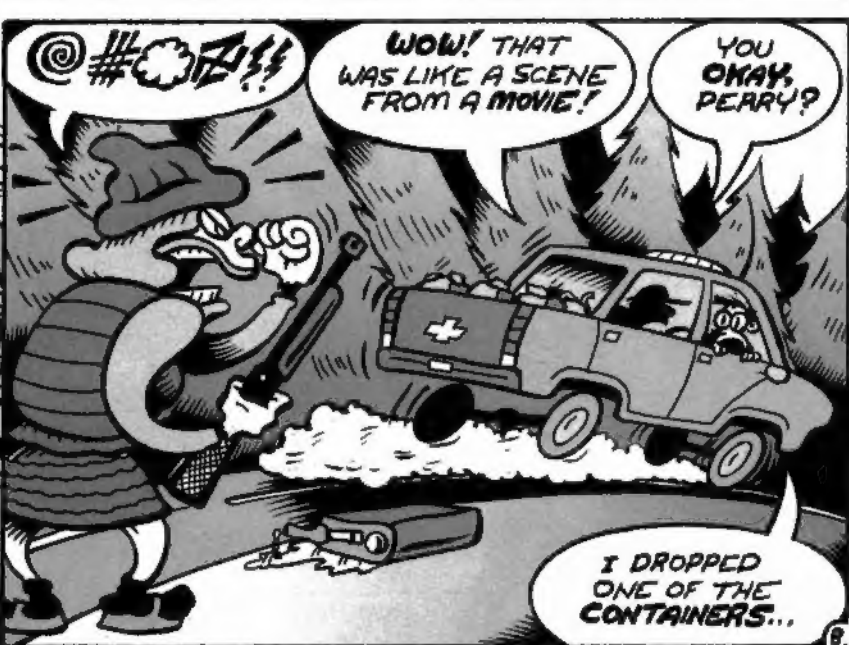














LATER...

...NINE CANS OF
SOUP, FOUR LOAVES
OF BREAD, AND A
JAR OF
PICKLES...

...I'D SAY I
DID A PRETTY GOOD
JOB OF SHOPPING,
ALL THINGS
CONSIDERED!

A
JAR
OF
PICKLES?



YES! PICKLES ARE
A PRESERVE, WHICH
IS A GOOD THING,
SINCE WE DON'T
HAVE A FRIDGE...

I
WAS
THINKING
AHEAD,
SEE?

DO YOU
KNOW HOW MUCH
NUTRITION IS IN A
JAR OF PICKLES?
NONE! NADA!



AND DID YOU HAVE
TO BUY WHITE BREAD?
THIS STUFF IS FULL OF
PRESERVATIVES!

OF COURSE!
THAT'S WHY I
BOUGHT 'EM!

NOW
WILL YOU PLEASE
STOP BEING SUCH
A CUNT?!









STILL, I CAN'T BELIEVE YOU'RE NOT FREAKING OUT OVER ALL THIS...

HEY, ONE OF US HAS TO KEEP IT TOGETHER!



BUT IT'S ALMOST AS IF YOU'RE ENJOYING THE SITUATION...

YA KNOW WHAT? IN A WAY I KINDA AM...



DON'T GET ME WRONG — IT'S NOT LIKE I'M GLAD OUR HOME TOWN BLEW UP...

BUT TO BE HONEST, I'VE ALWAYS FANTASIZED ABOUT TESTING MY SURVIVAL SKILLS...



LIKE, YESTERDAY I WAS JUST SOME LOWLIFE BOTTOM-FEEDER, YA KNOW? BUT NOW I FEEL LIKE I CAN PROVE WHAT I'M REALLY MADE OF!

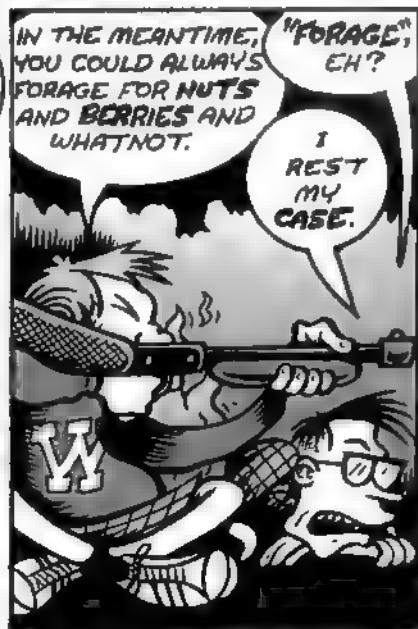
HUH. I'M FEELING THE EXACT OPPOSITE.



YESTERDAY I WAS THE HOTSHOT CAREER GUY, REMEMBER?

NOW I'M MR. NOTHING. I FEEL TOTALLY USELESS.

NO YOU'RE NOT! BESIDES, I COULD TEACH YOU HOW TO HUNT AND FISH...



IN THE MEANTIME, YOU COULD ALWAYS FORAGE FOR NUTS AND BERRIES AND WHATNOT.

"FORAGE," EH?

I REST MY CASE.



HEY! WHAT IF THE CABIN OWNER SHOWS UP WHILE YOU'RE OUT HUNTING?

HOLD ON, I'VE GOT SOMETHING YOU COULD USE...

HOW WILL I PROTECT MYSELF?



...HERE YA GO.

?!?! WHAT THE HELL IS THIS?



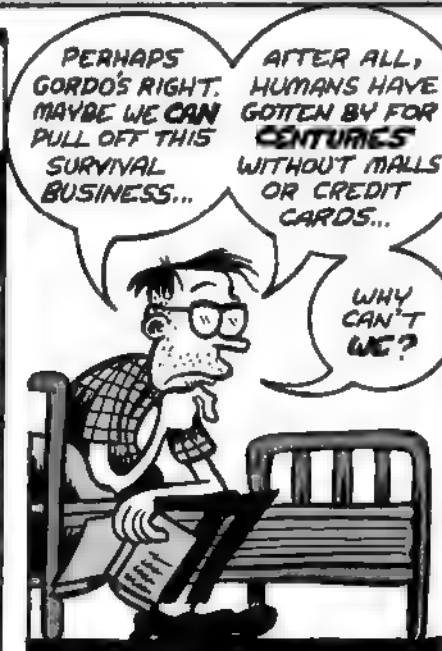
IT'S A FLARE GUN.

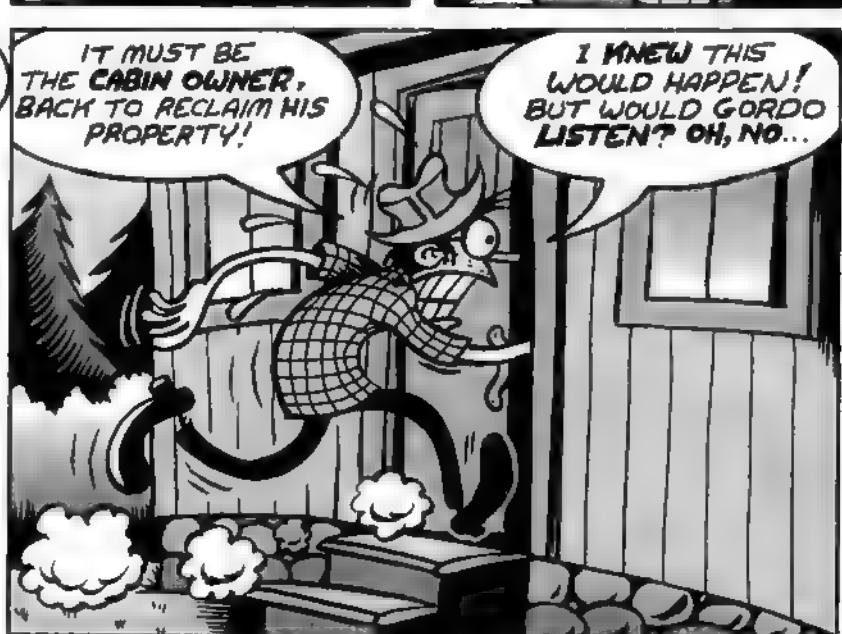
OH.

HOW... MESSY.



LATER THAT DAY...









?!?
WHAT ARE YOU
DOING?

SHE
ALMOST
GOT AWAY!

QUICK!
DO SOME
THING!

THRASH! THRASH!



I THOUGHT
SHE WAS
BADLY
WOUNDED...

NOT
THAT BAD,
OBVIOUSLY!

NOW WILL YOU
SHOOT THE DAMN
THING?! SHE'S
KICKING THE CRAP
OUTTA ME!



BUT, I DON'T
KNOW HOW TO
USE A GUN!

I'M THE
FORAGER,
REMEMBER?

JUST SHOOT HER
IN THE HEAD WITH THAT
FLARE GUN YOU'RE HOLDING!



SH-SHOOT
HER IN THE...
HEAD?

YES! THE
SOONER THE
BETTER!

THIS IS A
WEEK'S WORTH OF DINNER
I'M CLINGING TO HERE!



W-WHAT IF
I SHOOT YOU
INSTEAD?

PUT THE
MUZZLE
RIGHT ON
HER!

DO IT
NOW!



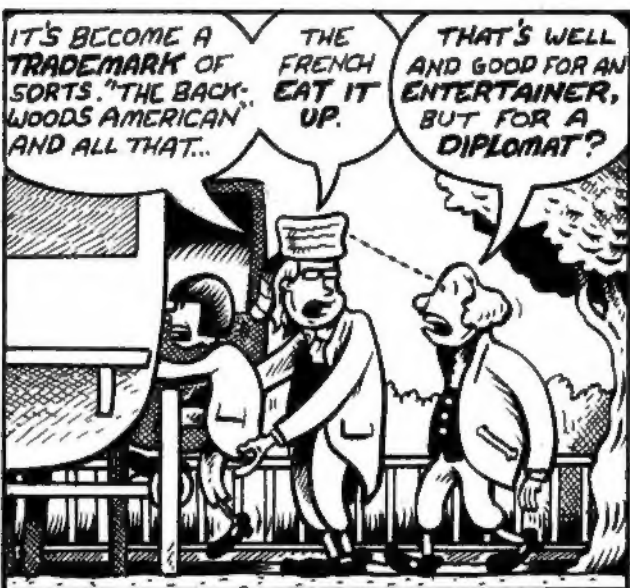
...WOW!
THAT WAS
AWESOME!

LOOK!
YOU GOT DEER
BRAINS ALL OVER
YA! HAW!

i'm
GONNA BE
SICK...

THE ODD COUPLE GO TO PARIS

SPRING, 1778...



WEEKS LATER, AT VERSAILLES...

I'M GLAD TO SEE YOU'VE FINALLY PULLED YOUR NOSE OUT OF YOUR BOOKS LONG ENOUGH TO JOIN US THIS EVENING, MR. ADAMS...

YOU TAKE YOUR DUTIES FAR TOO SERIOUSLY!

PROCURING PEACE AND INDEPENDENCE FOR AMERICA IS A SERIOUS BUSINESS, SIR.

"ADAMS" — AS IN ADAM AND EVE, NO?



I WONDER: HOW DID ADAM KNOW HOW TO MAKE LOVE TO EVE? DIVINE INTERVENTION, PERHAPS? HA HA!

GASP! SUCH IMPERTINENCE!

GISELLE, PLEASE! YOU'RE EMBARRASSING OUR SPECIAL GUEST! HA HA!

COME ALONG, QUINCY. IT'S PAST OUR BEDTIME...

WHERE'S THE OLD CONJURER*?

BUT, NO ONE GOES TO BED AT EIGHT AROUND HERE!



*ADAMS' NICKNAME FOR FRANKLIN.

GOOD GOD!

Wow!

... SO THE QUAKER SAYS TO THE MENNONITE: "YOU AND WHAT ARMY?"

AH HA HA! OH BENNY, YOU TELL THE FUNNIEST STORIES!

AND HE INVENTED BIFOCALS!



ISN'T HE AMAZING?

WE HAVE IMPORTANT BUSINESS TO DISCUSS, DOCTOR, BUT I SEE YOU'RE PREOCCUPIED, AS USUAL...

I TAKE IT YOU DON'T APPROVE OF MY DIPLOMATIC STYLE.



HEY! I CAN'T SEE!

HOW CAN WE CONVINCE THE FRENCH TO BACK US WHEN ONE OF US IS ACTING LIKE AN OLD FOOL!?

WE AREN'T EXACTLY DEALING WITH PURITANS HERE, JOHN...



OR HAVEN'T YOU NOTICED?

OH, I'VE NOTICED. ALRIGHT...

I'LL CALL ON YOU FIRST THING TOMORROW...

"EARLY TO BED, EARLY TO RISE"—RIGHT, DOCTOR?



BAH. WHO-EVER WROTE THAT WAS A YOUNG FOOL.

FALL, 1782...

ALL LANDS EAST
OF THE MISSISSIPPI,
UNRESTRICTED TRADE
WITH THE WEST
INDIES...

NOT A
BAD DEAL,
I'D SAY.

AND WE GOT
TOM COD* THROWN
IN FOR GOOD
MEASURE!

I'LL BE
THE TOAST OF
NEW ENGLAND!
HUZZAH!

I CAN'T BELIEVE
THE BRITISH SIGNED
THIS TREATY...

MAYBE
WE REALLY ARE
"CONJURERS" EH,
JOHN?



*FISHING RIGHTS

BAH! THIS
TOOK YEARS
LONGER THAN
IT SHOULD
HAVE...

AND THE
FRENCH WERE SO
USELESS WE HAD
TO NEGOTIATE
BEHIND THEIR
BACKS!



INDEED,
WHILE BREAKING OUR TREATY
WITH THEM IN THE PROCESS.

Y-YES,
THERE
IS
THAT...

ARE THE
FRENCH
VERY UPSET
WITH US,
DOCTOR?

THEY'RE
FURIOUS.
BUT THAT
WON'T STOP
US FROM
HITTING THEM
UP FOR
ANOTHER
LOAN.



SO WHAT'S NEXT FOR YOU, JOHN?
OUR SUCCESS HERE SHOULD
OPEN MANY POLITICAL DOORS
FOR YOU...

PLEASE.



I'M NOT IN
THIS FOR THE
GLORY..

I MISS MY
ABIGAIL, AND
MY HUMBLE
FARM...

IF I CAN GET
MY LAW PRACTICE
GOING AGAIN, I'LL
BE HAPPY...



GOODNIGHT,
GENTLEMEN. IT'S WAY PAST
THIS FARMER'S BEDTIME...

WELL, I GUESS
THAT'S THE
LAST WE'LL
BE HEARING
FROM MR.
ADAMS.

WHAT? DON'T
TELL ME YOU
BOUGHT THAT
LITTLE SONG
AND DANCE
OF HIS!



?!?
WHY
WOULDN'T I
TAKE HIM
AT HIS
WORD?

BECAUSE
THAT "HUMBLE
NEW ENGLAND
FARMER" IS THE
BIGGEST EGOTIST
I'VE EVER MET.



END

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